

Hatching out

Making or finding a nest is a lot of work for birds, but looking after the eggs and chicks is even harder!

Inside the eggs, each chick grows using the yolk as food.

Blue tit chicks

Nest birds

The mother bird sits on her nest keeping the eggs warm until they hatch. When they are born, they need constant feeding until they can look after themselves.

At one day old, the bald chicks are very hungry.

At three days old, the chicks are demanding constant food. Their bright mouths are easily seen by parents.

After two weeks, there is barely enough room to move. The chicks are now ready to fly away.

At nine days, their feathers are starting to appear and the nest is getting crowded.

Baby birds

There are two types of young bird. Nest birds are born blind and naked and depend completely on their parents. The other type, like ducklings, hatch with open eyes and a coat of downy feathers.

The chick has an egg tooth that it uses to poke through the shell.

It then pushes against both ends and breaks itself out of the egg.

Duckling

Waterbirds

Waterbirds are often born on the ground rather than in nests, so they have to be able to get out of danger quickly. Ducklings take to water very soon after hatching.



Egg tooth

